Gmail Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

Queries on admission requirements and other details regarding Medicine A100 at Aston

6 messages

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com> 25 January 2024 at 20:17
To: ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk

Hello

I hope you are well.

I had some questions regarding the entry requirements for Medicine A100.

The normal requirements are A*AA or above, but you mention you can make reduced offers to applicants who meet certain criteria. You also accept people who have completed other degrees. But, other degrees can, and do, vary enormously in the academic calibre of the students on that course.

There are hundreds of degrees at many universities across the UK with very varied entry requirements.

Think about how varied the academic attainment is of the final University student body. Huge. Enormous. So, anyone can complete a degree. Solely completing a degree does not mean you are fit to practise Medicine if you only went to a university that asked for BCC. Or DDD.

Many entry requirements only ask for C and B grades and don’t take GCSE grades into account.

Many A Level subjects, as determined by research, also do not correlate with GCSE grades due to the lack of academic rigour involved.

Science A Levels have been determined by empirical research as having the highest academic difficulty and the highest correlate with GCSE grades. Those who excel in A Level Chemistry or Biology, have, you can be rest assured, by and large, also excelled in their GCSE’s.

So, therefore, your average UK university student is unlikely to have excelled in their A Levels or their GCSE’s. Which makes sense, as you don’t need to have done well in school to work in many occupations.

Conversely, looking at the entry requirements for all UK Medical School, Dental School and Veterinary Science schools you will find they are ***looking for exactly the opposite. They want people who have excelled in A Levels. Which is why such high requirements exist for these particular fields.***

In effect, lowering standards for these very highly valued occupations is actually demeaning to the thousands of Medical students who have put in incredible effort to achieve top grades when “anyone can now get in regardless of their grades”. So what is the point of asking for high requirements in the first place, may I ask?

What is the point of these high standards then, of A*AA, as stated on the course website? What is the point when anyone can bypass these very high requirements, even someone with low or average A Levels, and still enter? Clearly, your entry requirements that only admit the top percentiles taking A Levels make it clear that the course is not suitable for those with CCC. Otherwise, why do you exclude people with C’s and B’s in Chemistry but admit those with A*’s and A’s?

Perhaps a more suitable way, and one you may be able to help me on, is looking at matched OECD PISA test results for those students who were successful at entering the course Medicine A100.

For reference, OECD (The organisation for economic cooperation and development) runs a study every 3 years called PISA, where students around the world are given a score based on their measured proficiency in Maths and Science. The Department of Education has access to the full student database and the ability to match scores to various levels of attainment. So, theoretically, they can do this for universities too,

By convening with the Department of Education, you can find out what the OECD PISA 2018 results were for students who gained successful admission into your course Medicine A100.

The Department can help you with this by matching PISA scores to those pupils from the National Pupil Database who ended up with successful admission into Medicine at Aston.

Is this something that you can help me with? Or something that can be arranged by means of an FOI request?

By collaborating with the Department of Education, you, as the university, can greatly aid me in finding out this information so that I can discover what the effects of such stringent requirements actually are, and whether, also, lowering such requirements in certain instances has any effect on the calibre of students who are eventually admitted. This may actually prove to be useful data to yourselves at the university also, as your students can then also be empirically given a metric on an international global standardised scale. It may also prove that the lowered admission offers do not actually reduce student calibre.

It will also provide valuable insight into the type of student that ends up with successful admission, after the intensely selective and intensely demanding selection process.

I would be extremely grateful if you could help me with this matter and aid in finding this information for me, by collaborating with the Department of education.

data.sharing@education.gov.uk

Please ask for “matched PISA 2018 Maths and Science score for those students who went onto gain admission into Medicine A100 at Aston University”

As a side, I applied to Medicine in England, with spectacular predicated grades of A*A*A and several grade 9’s (A) at GCSE and a phenomenal track record. It seems frankly unfair that Medicine rejects people like myself but accepts people who have solely a degree (no mention of how they did or what they needed to enter…)**

Many thanks

Tom Piccolo

Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk> 26 January 2024 at 10:43
To: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

Dear Tom,

Thank you for your email. As entry to Medicine is so very competitive, all universities have to have entry requirements as they see fit. Like other Medical Schools, we believe our entry requirements to be the fairest possible and everything is approved by the GMC.

At Aston we do not let in graduates with just any GCSE and A Level grades. As stated on our website https://www.aston.ac.uk/study/courses/medicine-mbchb/september-2024 current graduate requirements are:

For applicants taking a degree, a minimum of an upper second class Honours degree (2:1) in any discipline plus three A Levels at grades ABB to include Chemistry and Biology with either at grade A. The university degree must be from a recognised UK ENIC (the UK National Information Centre for global qualifications and skills) approved university.

In addition, applicants will be required to have the same GCSE requirements as stated above. We do not accept transfers from applicants currently studying degrees at other universities. We would always expect applicants to apply to Aston Medical School in the final year of their degree programme. Although we are happy to consider applications from graduates, there is no accelerated graduate entry available at Aston. All graduates will have to complete the same five-year programme as for all other students.

You mention that you have been rejected from medical schools. You have not provided a UCAS ID number, but from searching by your name and email address, it does not appear that you actually applied to Aston University. You may therefore wish to take this up with the medical schools you did apply to.

Kind Regards,

Rhiannon

Rhiannon Bird

Undergraduate Admissions Officer

Aston Medical School

Admissions, Recruitment and Outreach

F Aston University, Aston Triangle, Birmingham, B4 7ET

(0121 204 3030

: **www.aston.ac.uk**

If you are an applicant, please do ensure that you include either your UCAS Personal ID Number or Aston Student Number in all emails. This helps us to find you on our system more efficiently.

From: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
Sent: Thursday, January 25, 2024 8:18 PM
To: Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk>
Subject: Queries on admission requirements and other details regarding Medicine A100 at Aston

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[Quoted text hidden]

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com> 26 January 2024 at 14:36
To: Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk>

Hello

I had a question

There are some university courses with entry requirements of BCC, whereas others ask for A*A*A. Is this to do with the academic difficulty of the course content? Does it mirror it in any way? As in, the very high requirements of two a stars mirror somewhat the course academic difficulty; in that it is not suitable for those with lower grades.

Even you acknowledged this as you said you do not just allow people with any a level or GCSE grades to enter the course; their grades must still be quite high.

Many thanks,

Tom

[Quoted text hidden]

Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk> 26 January 2024 at 15:09
To: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

Dear Tom,

Entry requirements are usually set relating to factors such as academic difficulty / course content and how competitive entry is.

Kind Regards,

Rhiannon

[Quoted text hidden]

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com> 26 February 2024 at 19:26
To: Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk>

Hello

You mentioned that entry requirements relate to course content and academic difficulty. Is this just for Medicine or does it apply to most/all university courses and degrees?

Many thanks

Tom

[Quoted text hidden]

Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk> 28 February 2024 at 13:14
To: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

Dear Tom,

Apologies, I thought you meant the sector more widely.

Yes, we have to ensure students are academically capable to do well on their enrolled course.

Kind regards,

Tom

Tom Matthes-Buck

Undergraduate Admissions Manager

Admissions, Student Recruitment and Outreach

Admissions, Recruitment and Outreach
Aston University
Aston Triangle
Birmingham, B4 7ET, UK
0121 204 3030

www.aston.ac.uk

From: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
Sent: Wednesday, February 28, 2024 11:42 AM
To: Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk>
Subject: Re: Queries on admission requirements and other details regarding Medicine A100 at Aston

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Hello

I meant at Aston not elsewhere.

You mentioned that entry requirements relate to course content and academic difficulty. Is this just for Medicine or does it apply to most/all university courses and degrees?

Many thanks

Tom

On Wed, 28 Feb 2024 at 11:40, Undergraduate Admissions <ugadmissions@aston.ac.uk> wrote:

> Dear Tom,
>
> Thank you for your email.
>
> We can’t comment on other universities and their rationale for setting entry requirements.
>
> Many thanks
>
> Tom
>
> Tom Matthes-Buck
>
> **Undergraduate Admissions Manager**
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